

नाट्यशास्त्रप्रवर्तकं भरतमुनिं वन्दे ।

Nāṭyaśāstra-pravartakam Bharata Munim vande.



NĀMA • RŪPA NĀDA • BINDU

INAUGURAL IMMERSION

11-12 JULY 2026

PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK

A JOINT INITIATIVE OF



**NĀṬYĀŚĀSTRA
GURUKULAM**

A CENTRE FOR
CIVILISATIONAL STATECRAFT

&



AATMALAYA

ACADEMY OF ART &
CULTURE TRUST

From Immersion to Sādhana



NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU

INAUGURAL IMMERSION

11-12 JULY 2026 • NAVI MUMBAI

PREFACE

AN INVITATION

नाट्यं न केवलं दृश्यते; तद् अनुभूयते । न केवलं श्रूयते; तद् परिवर्तयति ॥

*Nāṭya is not merely performed; it is inhabited.
It is not merely observed; it transforms the observer.*

The *Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu* Immersion has been conceived as an exploration of the deeper civilisational vision of the *Nāṭyaśāstra*. Over two days, scholars, gurus, artists and practitioners from diverse disciplines come together to inquire into *Nāṭya* not simply as a performing art, but as a path of aesthetic refinement, contemplative practice, cultural continuity and inner transformation.

The four themes of this immersion offer complementary gateways into that journey:



Nāma – the power of language, mantra and meaning.



Rūpa – form, embodiment, iconography and sacred aesthetics.



Nāda – sound, music, rhythm and resonance.



Bindu – stillness, integration and the source from which expression arises.

Together, they illuminate Bharata Muni's vision of *Nāṭya* as a discipline that refines perception, harmonises emotion and nurtures the qualities essential for both individual flourishing and a healthy civilisation.

This handbook is intended simply as a companion to the immersion. It contains the programme schedule, faculty profiles and practical information to help you navigate the two days with ease. We encourage you to listen deeply, participate generously, engage in dialogue, and allow the conversations to continue long after the sessions conclude.

*May this immersion become not merely an event to attend,
but the beginning of a lifelong journey of study, practice and Sādhana.*

DR. PADMAJA SURESH

Director

Aatmalaya Academy of Art & Culture Trust

ROHIT VISWANATH

Yajamāna & Yojaka
Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu

DAY ONE

SATURDAY, 11 JULY 2026

Venue

BHARATIYA VIDYA BHAVAN, NAVI MUMBAI KENDRA
Plot 3A, Sector-30,
Vashi, Navi Mumbai – 400703



8:00 AM



Lamp Lighting • Prayer

8:15 AM



Breakfast

9:00 AM



Welcome & Orientation

Rohit Viswanath

*From Rasa to Rāma Rājya: Nāṭya and
the Making of Democratic Civilisation*

9:30 AM



Keynote Address by Padma Shri Prof. Bharat Gupt

Nāṭyaśāstra and its Modern Applications (Online)

10:15 AM



Nāṭyaśāstra and Trika Tantra: From Nāma to Rūpa

Dr. Padmaja Suresh

10:45 AM



The Temple and the Stage

Dr. Ujjwala Khot-Palsuley

11:15 AM



The Sūtra of the Chakras in the Performing Arts

Smt. Mandakini Trivedi

11:45 AM



Tea

Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu

DAY ONE

SATURDAY, 11 JULY 2026

(Continued)



12:00 PM



From Stone to Movement (Online)
Dr. Choodamani Nandagopal

12:45 PM



Aṅgika Abhinaya Leading to Sāttvika
Dr. Parul Shah

1:15 PM



Lunch

2:00 PM



The Circle of Rāsa Lilā in Indian Painting (Online)
Dr. Sujata Parsai

2:30 PM



Art as Inner Education
Smt. Chandra Anand

3:00 PM



Nāṭya as Ārādhana
Smt. Priyamvada Murali

3:30 PM



Guru-Śiṣya Paramparā
Smt. Veena Seshadri

4:00 PM



Tea

4:15 PM



Bindu: Silence as the Source of Nāṭya
Sri Ujwal Jagadeesh

4:45 PM



Rūpa as Revelation
Smt. Charanya Gurusatya

5:15 PM



Śabda to Nāda
Dr. Sriram Narainswamy Iyer

5:45 PM



Tarangam: The Union of Mind, Body and
Consciousness in Nāṭya
Smt. Deepa Sashindran

6:15 PM



Prakṛti as Guru: Nāṭya and the Cultivation
of Ecological Consciousness
Smt. Aparna Doddamalur

6:45 PM



Nava Rasa as Sādhana
Smt. Sujatha Ramanathan

7:15 PM



Saṅkalpa Circle

8:00 PM



Retiring for the Day
*Residential participants return to Uttarakhand Bhavan.
Dinner will be served upon arrival.*

Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu

DAY TWO

NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU
CULMINATION SABHĀ

SUNDAY, 12 JULY 2026

9:45 AM	 Guests Seated
10:00 AM	 Lighting of the Lamp Invocation (4 min) Ms. Shivangi Pandey
	 Welcome Address Dr. Padmaja Suresh

PERFORMANCES

- 1 Hamsa Ganesh 5 min
- 2 Dr. Parul Shah 5 min
- 3 Smt. Charanya Gurusathya & Ensemble 12 min
- 4 Rashmi R. Chowalloor & Vidhya S. 10 min
- 5 Smt. Veena Seshadri & Dhruti Shekhar 12 min
- 6 Aneri Sheth 6 min
- 7 Dr. Divya Patel 6 min
- 8 Sri Ujwal Jagadeesh 9 min

VENUE



Sri Shanmukhananda
Lion Dr. Ashok Mehta Auditorium
6th Floor, Tower Block
292, Comrade Harbanslal Marg
Behind Gandhi Market
Sion, Mumbai – 400022



HONOURS CEREMONY



AATMALAYA NATIONAL AWARD
FOR LIFETIME ACHIEVEMENT

Presented Posthumously to
GURU VASANT KUMAR



CHAKYAR RAJAN
MEMORIAL AWARD

Presented to
SRI P. BALAKRISHNAN (BALAJI)



FELICITATORY ADDRESSES
BY DISTINGUISHED GUESTS
(Approximately 30 minutes)

PERFORMANCES CONTINUE

- 9 Sreya Srinath & Aparna Doddamalur 12 min
- 10 Smt. Sujatha Ramanathan 10 min
- 11 Smt. Deepa Sashindran 10 min
- 12 Smt. Priyamvada Murali & Ensemble 10 min
- 13 Sri Mahesh Pandya 5 min
- 14 Sarvesh Venkatesh & Dr. Padmaja Suresh 9 min

CONCLUDING SESSION



VOTE OF THANKS
Dr. Padmaja Suresh
Rohit Viswanath





NĀṬYAŚĀSTRA
GURUKULAM

A CENTRE FOR
CIVILISATIONAL STATECRAFT



AATMALAYA
ACADEMY OF ART &
CULTURE TRUST

NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU

— INAUGURAL IMMERSION —

11–12 JULY 2026 • MUMBAI

MEET THE FACULTY

*The following scholars and practitioners
guide our exploration through
Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu.*

*Each session illuminates one facet of Nāṭya
as a path of artistic inquiry, contemplative
practice, and cultural continuity.*



— From Immersion to Sāadhanā —



ANUGRAHA SANDESHA

Padma Bhushan Dr. M. B. Athreya

Mentor & Marga Darshak
Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



Padma Bhushan Dr. M. B. Athreya is one of India's foremost management thinkers, educator, author, and institution builder. Over several decades, he has made enduring contributions to leadership development, corporate governance, public policy, and values-based management. He is the Mentor & Marga Darshak of Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam.

I invoke the *aseem Krupa* of Shiva , the Nataraja and of *Nartana Ganesha* on all of us and our shared Vision. Our *anavarata Vandana* to Bharata Muni.

As we know, *Natya* can benefit the Citizen and the Society in many ways. Let us focus on two aspects -- *Sringara*, without *Kama* & *Dharma*, without exceptions

You are *Parivartaks* for the Civilizational transformation. In *Bharat* and globally.

Our shared journey begins with this Immersion. *Shubha Aarambham bhavatu.*

My fervent *prarthanas* and *paripoorna ashirvadams*.

Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



AATMALAYA

Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu
IMMERSION SERIES

KEYNOTE ADDRESS

Padma Shri

Prof.
Bharat Gupt



SATURDAY,
JULY 11, 2026



9:30 AM

Padma Shri Prof. Bharat Gupt is one of India's foremost scholars of *Nāṭyaśāstra*, Indian aesthetics, musicology, and classical theatre. A distinguished classicist, musician, theatre theorist, and cultural thinker, he has devoted decades to exploring the philosophical and civilizational foundations of the performing arts. His work has illuminated the enduring relevance of Bharata's *Nāṭyaśāstra* for contemporary culture, education, and human flourishing. Through scholarship, teaching, and public engagement, Prof. Gupt has inspired generations to rediscover *Nāṭya* as a pathway to knowledge, aesthetic refinement, and inner transformation, rooted in the wisdom of India's artistic traditions.

VENUE



Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra

ADMISSION ONLY FOR REGISTERED PARTICIPANTS



Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



AATMALAYA

IMMERSION SERIES

NĀDA • BINDU • NĀMA • RŪPA NĀṬYA AND TRIKA TANTRA

*Exploring the journey from Nāda to Bindu,
and from Nāma to Rūpa, through the
transformative wisdom of Nāṭya and Trika Tantra.*



SATURDAY
JULY 11, 2026



10:15 AM

with

Dr. Padmaja Suresh

BHARATANĀṬYAM ARTISTE • RESEARCHER • AUTHOR • EDUCATOR

Dr. Padmaja Suresh is a Bharatanāṭyam artiste, researcher, author, and educator whose work bridges artistic practice, metaphysical inquiry, and Indian knowledge traditions. Trained in the classical dance tradition and informed by decades of scholarship, teaching, and international cultural engagement, she explores the deeper philosophical and spiritual dimensions of Nāṭya.

Through her performances, writings, research, and educational initiatives, Dr. Padmaja investigates how movement, symbolism, sound, and consciousness become vehicles for inner transformation. Her longstanding engagement with the esoteric foundations of Indian aesthetics makes her uniquely positioned to guide participants into the subtle relationship between art, contemplation, and ātmajñāna.



Venue

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Navi Mumbai Kendra
Admission only for registered participants.

नाम

NĀMA
The Word



RŪPA
The Form



NĀDA
The Sound



BINDU
The Point

*From Nāma to Rūpa, from Nāda to Bindu,
Nāṭya leads us from expression to essence.*



Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



AATMALAYA

Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu

IMMERSION SERIES

SESSION BY

Dr. Ujjwala Khot-Palsuley

*Conservation Architect • Researcher
Scholar of India's Traditional
Knowledge Systems*

SESSION TOPIC

The Temple and the Stage:
Shared Foundations of
Indian Aesthetic Thought



SATURDAY
JULY 11, 2026



10:45 AM
(IST)

Dr. Ujjwala Khot-Palsuley is a scholar of sacred architecture and India's traditional knowledge systems. Through her research on Indian and Southeast Asian temple traditions, she explores how civilizations embody knowledge through form, space, symbolism and lived experience.

Her work reveals architecture as a vehicle of meaning and memory across generations, offering a profound perspective on *Rūpa* and its intimate connection to the arts, culture and aesthetic vision of India.



VENUE

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Navi Mumbai Kendra

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Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



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Smt. MANDAKINI TRIVEDI

*Dancer • Choreographer • Mentor
Researcher • Cultural Educationist
Author*

SESSION TOPIC
The Sūtra of
Chakra-s in the
Performing Arts



SATURDAY
JULY 11, 2026



11:15 AM

A celebrated Mohini Āṭṭam exponent, mentor, researcher, and Sangeet Natak Akademi Awardee, Smt. Mandakini Trivedi explores Indian dance as a pathway of inner transformation. Through her pioneering work at Nateshvari Dance Gurukul, she integrates yogic principles and the meditative dimensions of the Nāṭyaśāstra Karaṇas, revealing dance as embodied yoga. Author of *The Yoga of Indian Dance*, *Sutras on Dance* and *'Ananda Yoga – Conversations on Happiness'*, her insights illuminate the relationship between movement, energy, consciousness and aesthetic experience.



VENUE
Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra

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Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



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IMMERSION SERIES

From Stone to Movement: Indian Sculpture, Śāstra, and Prayoga

with

Dr. Choodamani Nandagopal

ART HISTORIAN & SCHOLAR
OF INDIAN SCULPTURE, TEMPLE
ARCHITECTURE & CULTURAL HERITAGE

Dr. Choodamani Nandagopal is one of India's foremost art historians and scholars of Indian sculpture, temple architecture, and cultural heritage. Her work has illuminated the profound dialogue between Śāstra and Prayoga, revealing how India's sculptural traditions preserve the principles of music, dance, ritual, and sacred space in enduring visual form.

A former Academic Head of the Southern Regional Centre of the Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA), she has led pioneering research on temple traditions, sacred architecture, and Indian iconography. Her internationally acclaimed scholarship includes landmark publications such as *Dance and Music in Temple Architecture*, *Temple Treasures*, *Classical Dance Heritage of Karnataka*, and *The Art of Image Making*.

Recipient of several prestigious national and international research fellowships, she has collaborated with leading universities, museums, and cultural institutions across India and abroad.

She invites us to rediscover sculpture not as static art, but as the living embodiment of movement, rhythm, and aesthetic knowledge, where the principles of Nāṭya are eternally preserved in stone.



At Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra

Admission only for registered participants.



**JULY 11
SATURDAY**



**12:00 PM
ONLINE SESSION**

*From Stone to Movement:
Indian Sculpture,
Śāstra, and Prayoga*



Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



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IMMERSION SERIES

Prof. Dr.
**PARUL
SHAH**

Artist • Guru • Scholar •
Arts Administrator • Cultural Leader

SESSION TOPIC
**Angika Abhinaya
Leading to Sāttvika**
*From Embodied Expression
to Inner Resonance*



SATURDAY,
JULY 11, 2026



12:45 PM

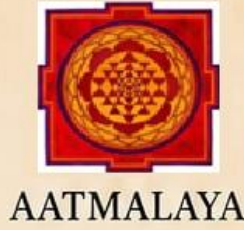
Prof. Dr. Parul Shah is a distinguished dancer, teacher, scholar, and cultural leader whose life's work bridges performance, scholarship, and cultural heritage. With over six decades of engagement in Bharatanatyam, folk traditions, choreography, research, and arts education, she brings deep insight into the living traditions of India. A pioneering scholar of Gujarat's Rāsa traditions and a leading voice in the field of intangible cultural heritage, she continues to inspire generations through her artistry, scholarship, and dedication to the performing arts.



VENUE
**Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra**

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Nātyaśāstra
Gurukulam




NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU
IMMERSION SERIES


Circle of Rāsa Līlā

in Indian painting


Sujata Parsai

Museum professional, art historian
and educator with a passion
for connecting cultural and
artistic heritage to the public.


She is currently the Director of the
Lalbhai Dalpatbhai Museum, Ahmedabad.

At Bharatiya Vidya bhavan,
Navi Mumbai kendra,
Admission only for registered participants.


JULY 11
SATURDAY


2:00 PM


Online Talk


Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



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IMMERSION SERIES

Art as Inner Education: *The Dharma of Nāṭya*

*Exploring how Nāṭya nurtures
not only aesthetic sensitivity but also
discernment, character, and ethical as well
as spiritual awareness.*

with
Smt. Chandra Anand

Bharatanāṭyam Exponent

AUTHOR • REVIEWER • EDUCATOR

Smt. Chandra Anand approaches Nāṭya as a discipline through which artistic excellence and inner refinement become one. Enriched by sustained scholarship, performance, and reflective writing, she explores how Nāṭya nurtures not only aesthetic sensitivity but also discernment, character, and ethical as well as spiritual awareness.

Through her book *Education in Spiritual Values through Bharatanatyam*, her writings, and decades of artistic practice, she has consistently affirmed that the true purpose of classical dance extends beyond performance to the refinement of consciousness.

Her work reminds us that Nāṭya is not merely an art to be mastered, but a lifelong path of inner education through which beauty, wisdom, and character are cultivated together.



At Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra

Admission only for registered participants.

**JULY 11
SATURDAY**

2:30 PM

*Art as Inner Education:
The Dharma of Nāṭya*

Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



AATMALAYA

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IMMERSION SERIES

Nāṭya as Ārādhana: The Living Temple Tradition of Dance and Music

with

Smt. Priyamvadha Murali

BHAGAVATA MELA EXPONENT
TEACHER • MENTOR • CULTURAL LEADER

- 🌸 Smt. Priyamvadha Murali belongs to the living Bhāgavata Mela tradition, where *Nāṭya* is not performed for the stage alone, but offered as worship, lived as discipline, and transmitted through *paramparā*.
- 🌸 Raised within an unbroken hereditary lineage, she embodies a vision in which music, dance, theatre, ritual, and community remain integral expressions of Sanātana Dharma.
- 🌸 Through Bhagavata Mela Vidyalaya, she continues this sacred work by nurturing young minds within a tradition where art becomes a means of inner refinement and cultural continuity.
- 🌸 Her presence reminds us that the deepest purpose of *Nāṭya* is not performance, but transformation.

At Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Navi Mumbai Kendra,
Admission only for registered participants.



**JULY 11
SATURDAY**

3:00 PM

*Nāṭya as Ārādhana:
The Living Temple Tradition
of Dance and Music*


Nāṭyaśāstra
Gurukulam



NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU
IMMERSION SERIES

Guru–Śiṣya Paramparā:

Where Tattva
Becomes Prayoga

with
Smt. Veena Chikkanahalli Seshadri

BHARATANĀṬYAM ARTISTE,
EDUCATOR AND CULTURAL AMBASSADOR

Smt. Veena Seshadri embodies a vision of Bharatanāṭyam in which tattva and prayoga (wisdom and embodied practice) remain inseparable. Rooted in the Kalākṣetra tradition and enriched through lifelong study, performance, and teaching, she approaches Nāṭya as a sacred discipline through which philosophy becomes lived experience. Through Kala Sampada, the institution she founded, and through her performances, choreographic works, lecture-demonstrations, and cultural initiatives across India and the world, she has dedicated herself to nurturing not merely accomplished performers, but discerning custodians of Bharatiya knowledge traditions. Her work reminds us that the true continuity of a civilisation lies not in preserving its outer forms, but in transmitting the inner vision that gives those forms meaning, vitality, and enduring life.



At Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra

Admission only for registered participants.



JULY 11
SATURDAY

3:30 PM

*Guru–Śiṣya Paramparā:
Where Tattva
Becomes Prayoga*

NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU
IMMERSION SERIES

Sri Ujwal Jagadeesh

Performer, Teacher,
Researcher & Mentor



Sri Ujwal Jagadeesh approaches Nāṭya as a sacred discipline through which artistic practice becomes a path of contemplation and self-inquiry. Inspired by the teachings of Bhagavan Sri Ramana Maharshi, he explores how artistic expression can become a means of returning attention to its source, where silence, awareness, and authentic presence converge.



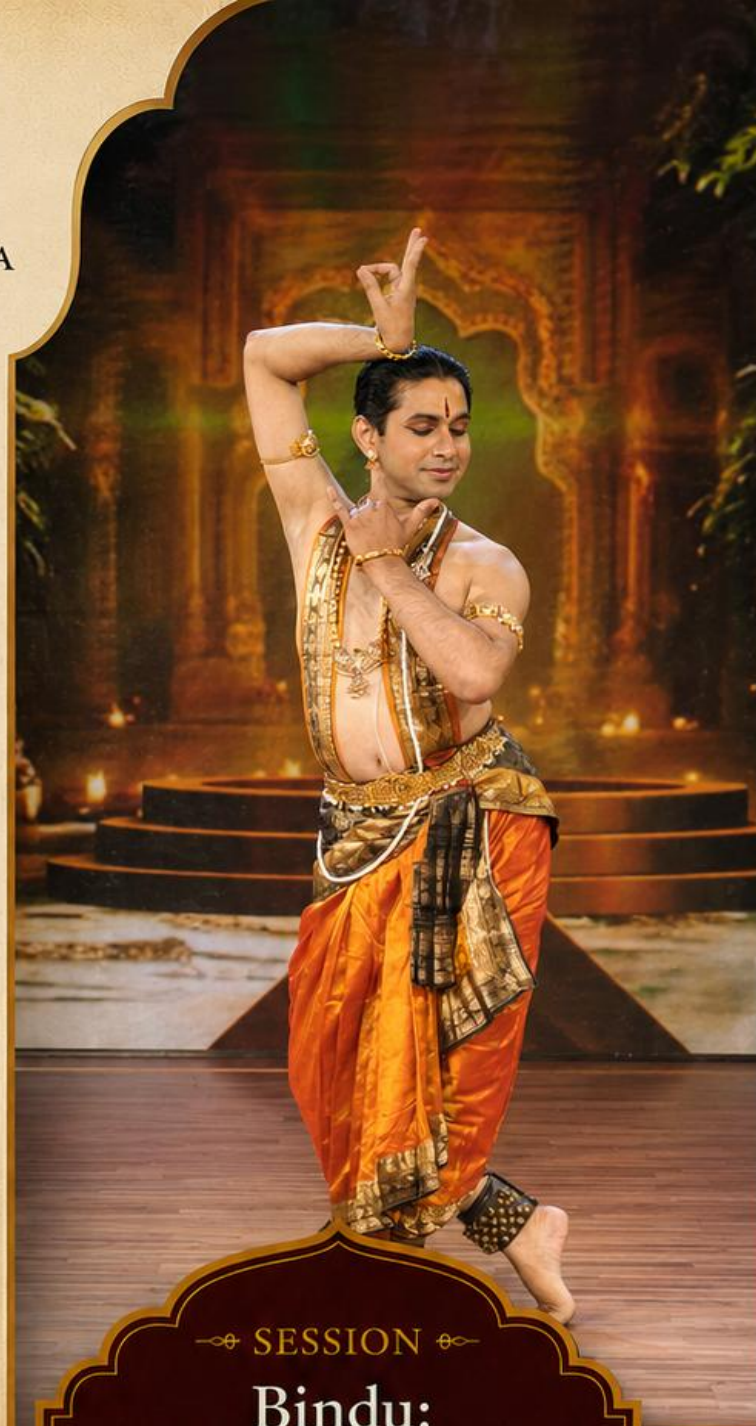
Enriched by rigorous training across Bharatanāṭyam, abhinaya, theatre, and allied traditions, and informed by sustained research into Indian aesthetic thought, he seeks to illuminate the deeper spiritual vision that animates the performing arts.



Through his work as performer, teacher, researcher, and mentor, he encourages artists to encounter Nāṭya not merely as a repertoire of forms, but as an embodied means of contemplation, self-transformation, and cultural continuity.



At Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra,
Admission only for registered participants.



SESSION

Bindu:
Silence as the
Source of Nāṭya



JULY 11
SATURDAY



4:15 PM




Nāṭyaśāstra
Gurukulam



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IMMERSION

Rūpa as Revelation:

Encountering the
Daśa Mahāvidyās
through Nāṭya



with

Smt. Charanya Gurusathya

— ARTISTIC DIRECTOR & SCHOLAR —

Smt. Charanya Gurusathya approaches Nāṭya as a sacred journey through which the visible form (rūpa) becomes a gateway to the deeper principles it embodies. Rooted in a rigorous Bharatanāṭyam lineage and enriched by sustained scholarship, research, choreography, and teaching, she explores how India's sacred iconography and textual traditions may be experienced not merely as objects of devotion, but as living realities through artistic embodiment.

Through Natyashala Academy of Fine Arts, the institution she founded, and through her performances, research, and pedagogic initiatives, she has cultivated an environment where disciplined practice, intellectual inquiry, and spiritual sensitivity grow together.

Her work reminds us that the true purpose of Nāṭya is not simply to portray divine forms, but to reveal the timeless consciousness they signify, transforming rūpa into a path of inner revelation.



At Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra

Admission only for registered participants.

JULY 11
SATURDAY

4:45 PM

*Rūpa as Revelation:
Encountering the
Daśa Mahāvidyās
through Nāṭya*

Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



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NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU
IMMERSION SERIES

SESSION BY

Dr. Sriram Narainswamy Iyer

*Sanskrit Scholar • Choreographer
Practitioner of South Indian Classical Music
Teacher • Composer • Cultural Educator*

SESSION TOPIC

Śabda to Nāda: Sanskrit, Music, and Vācika Abhinaya



SATURDAY
JULY 11, 2026



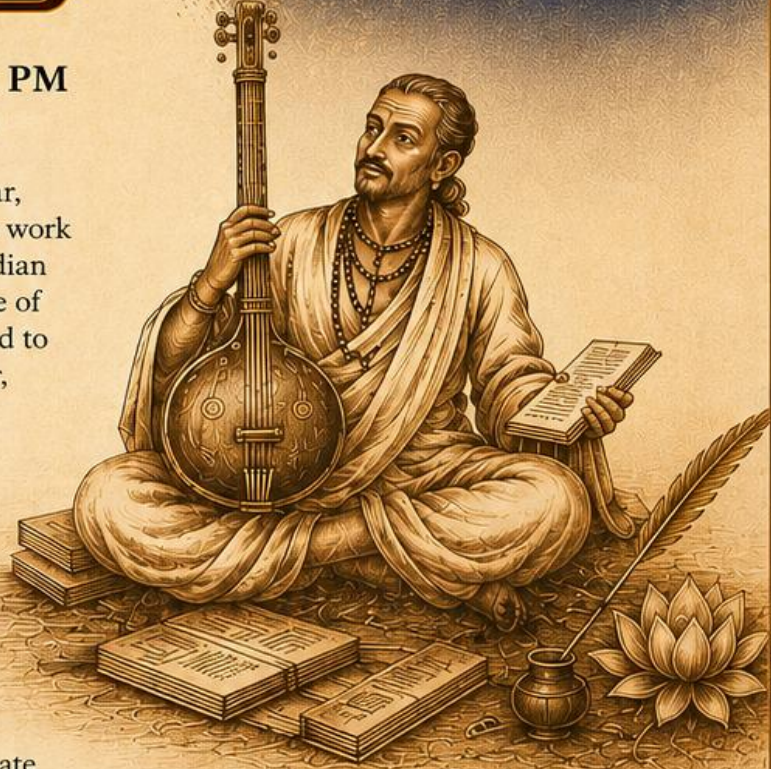
5:15 PM
(IST)

Dr. Sriram Narainswamy Iyer is a Sanskrit scholar, choreographer, musician, composer, and educator whose work bridges language, music, and performance within the Indian tradition. He belongs to the distinguished artistic lineage of **Kalāsadan, Mumbai**, the pioneering institution dedicated to Nāṭya and Śāstrīya Saṅgīta, founded by his grandfather, the late **Guru Shri Maṇi**.

As a Sanskrit scholar, he is associated with several institutions including the Department of Sanskrit, University of Mumbai, The SIES College, K J Somaiya Bharatiya Sanskriti Peetham, and Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan.

His areas of specialization and interest include Sanskrit literature, Vedānta, Itihāsa–Purāṇas, Saṅgīta–Nāṭya and the Dharma–śāstras.

Rooted in deep study and practice, he explores the intimate relationship between śabda, nāda, and expression.

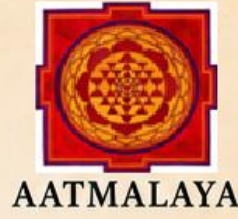


VENUE
**Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra**

ADMISSION ONLY FOR REGISTERED PARTICIPANTS

PRESERVING TRADITION • EXPRESSING DEVOTION • INSPIRING GENERATIONS

Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU
IMMERSION SERIES

SMT. DEEPA SASHINDRAN

with

KUCHIPUDI PRACTITIONER
CHOREOGRAPHER • EDUCATOR • CULTURAL LEADER

SESSION TOPIC

Tarangam: The Union of Mind, Body, and Consciousness in Nāṭya

*Exploring how the iconic Tarangam
reveals the integration of body, rhythm,
awareness, and consciousness at the
heart of Kuchipudi.*

Smt. Deepa Sashindran represents a rare confluence of artistic lineage, institutional vision, and cultural leadership. Rooted in the illustrious *paramparā* of Guru Smt. Manju Bhargavi and Padma Bhushan Dr. Vempati Chinna Satyam, she approaches Kuchipudi as a living tradition that is sustained through rigorous *sāadhanā*, creative fidelity, and purposeful transmission. Through the Kuchipudi Parampara Foundation, her performances, choreographic works, festivals, and pedagogic initiatives have created an ecosystem where artists inherit not merely a repertoire, but a living tradition. Her work reminds us that the true measure of a tradition lies not in the brilliance of individual performers, but in its capacity to nurture generations who carry its spirit forward with integrity, imagination, and devotion.



At Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Navi Mumbai Kendra.
Admission only for registered participants.

**JULY 11
SATURDAY**

5:45 PM

*Tarangam:
The Union of Mind, Body,
and Consciousness in Nāṭya*

Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



AATMALAYA

NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU
IMMERSION

Prakṛti as Guru: Nāṭya and the Cultivation of Ecological Consciousness

with

Smt. Aparna Doddamalur

Founder, Aatmanivedana Arts
California, USA

Smt. Aparna Doddamalur is a senior disciple of Dr. Padmaja Suresh and the Founder of Aatmanivedana Arts, California. Rooted in the Tāñjāvūr Bharatanatyam tradition and deeply influenced by the Nāṭyaśāstra, she views Nāṭya as a path of Sāadhanā, inquiry, and inner transformation.

Her continued engagement with traditional knowledge systems, including Yakṣagāna, temple traditions, and interdisciplinary dialogues on art, spirituality, and culture, reflects her commitment to understanding Nāṭya within the larger fabric of Indian civilisation.

In her session, she explores how disciplined artistic practice awakens reverence for the natural world, revealing ecological harmony as an expression of Dharma rather than merely environmental responsibility.



At Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra

Admission only for registered participants.

**JULY 11
SATURDAY**

6:15 PM

*Prakṛti as Guru:
Nāṭya and the Cultivation
of Ecological
Consciousness*

Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



AATMALAYA

NĀMA • RŪPA • NĀDA • BINDU
IMMERSION SERIES

Smt. Sujatha Ramanathan

Bharatanāṭyam Exponent,
Choreographer, Educator,
Writer & Researcher

Smt. Sujatha Ramanathan embodies a vision of *Bharatanāṭyam* in which artistic excellence and inner refinement are inseparable.

Rooted in the classical lineage of *Bharatanāṭyam* and enriched through sustained study of *Nāṭyaśāstra*, *karaṇas*, and *abhinaya*, she approaches dance as a discipline that transforms the practitioner before it moves the audience.

Her choreographic, pedagogic, and research work illuminates the deeper purpose of *rasa*—not merely as aesthetic experience, but as a means of cultivating awareness, character, and wisdom.

By bringing together performance, contemplation, and education, she reminds us that the *rasa* experienced by the audience begins with the inner refinement of the artist.



At Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
Navi Mumbai Kendra,
Admission only for registered participants.



SESSION

Nava Rasa as Sādhana:
The Inner Journey
of the Artist



JULY 11
SATURDAY



6:45 PM



PRESERVING TRADITION. EXPRESSING DEVOTION. INSPIRING GENERATIONS.

NĀMA The Word • RŪPA The Form • NĀDA The Sound • BINDU The Point

DISTINGUISHED PARTICIPATING PRACTITIONERS

The inaugural Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu Immersion is enriched by the participation of accomplished practitioners and scholars who join the programme as fellow seekers.



Dr. Sucharita Khanna

BHARATANATYAM EXPONENT • CHOREOGRAPHER • SCHOLAR

An accomplished Bharatanatyam exponent, choreographer, educator, and researcher, Dr. Sucharita Khanna is the founder of Kalanidhi – Centre for Performing Arts and a distinguished disciple of the late Padma Bhushan Prof. C. V. Chandrasekhar. Equally at home in performance and scholarship, her work spans rigorous training, choreography, and research, with publications on Bharatanatyam pedagogy and the representation of dance in Indian art and temple traditions. Through her teaching, creative productions, and academic inquiry, she continues to contribute significantly to the preservation, interpretation, and transmission of the classical dance heritage of Bhārata.



Prateesha Suresh

DANCER • RESEARCHER • EDUCATOR

Prateesha Suresh is a classical dancer and researcher whose work explores the fertile dialogue between artistic practice, textual traditions, and contemporary scholarship. Rooted in the Guru–Śiṣya Paramparā and informed by sustained research, she engages with manuscripts, gesture traditions, Pūrvaraṅga in Āṅkiyā Bhāṇā, and the aesthetics of bhakti and bhāvanā. Through performance, teaching, and interdisciplinary inquiry, she seeks to build meaningful bridges between inherited knowledge systems and contemporary artistic practice.



Pavitra Bhat

BHARATANATYAM EXPONENT • CHOREOGRAPHER • GURU

Recipient of the Sangeet Natak Akademi's Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar, Pavitra Bhat is widely recognised for his dynamic artistry, precise nṛtta, and sensitive abhinaya. Founder of P.A.V.I. (Pavitra Art Visual Institute), he has dedicated himself to nurturing the next generation of dancers while expanding audiences for Bharatanatyam through thoughtful choreography and accessible artistic presentations. His work exemplifies the seamless integration of performance excellence, pedagogy, and cultural stewardship within the living traditions of Bhāratiya Nāṭya.



Dr. Suman Badami

BHARATANATYAM EXPONENT • SCHOLAR • EDUCATOR

Dr. Suman Badami is a Bharatanatyam exponent, educator, and Director of Natya Vimarsha Centre for Dance, Mumbai. Trained in the Vazhuvoor tradition under Kalaimamani Sri S. K. Kameswaran and Smt. Saroja Kameswaran, she combines decades of performance and teaching with sustained academic inquiry. She holds a Ph.D. from the University of Mumbai on the aesthetic and philosophical concepts of Classical Indian Dance and is the recipient of a Senior Fellowship from the Ministry of Culture, Government of India, for her research on Bharatanatyam and traditional aesthetics. Through performance, scholarship, and pedagogy, her work seeks to illuminate the enduring dialogue between Nāṭya, aesthetics, philosophy, and the living cultural traditions of Bhārata.



COMMUNITY OF PRACTICE

Continuing the Journey



SHRI MAHESH PANDYA

Founder of Kaustubh Art & Cultural Centre, **Shri Mahesh Pandya**, a disciple and long-standing collaborator of Prof. Dr. Parul Shah, has devoted nearly four decades to the practice and promotion of theatre, dance, music, and cultural education. A performer, choreographer, and institution builder, he is committed to making the arts a vibrant force for community participation, cultural preservation, and intergenerational learning.



SARVESH VENKATESH

A musician, educator, and alumnus of the Institute of Contemporary Music Performance, London, **Sarvesh Venkatesh** brings together Indian and global musical traditions through performance and pedagogy. His work reflects a commitment to Nāda as a living medium of artistic dialogue, cultural continuity, and shared human experience.



DR. DIVYA PATEL

A Bharatanatyam dancer, scholar, and Assistant Professor at The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda, **Dr. Divya Patel**, a disciple of Prof. Dr. Parul Shah, seamlessly integrates performance, research, and teaching in her artistic journey. Rooted in the Guru-Śiṣya Paramparā, she approaches Nāṭya as a discipline of inquiry, refinement, and the preservation of India's classical knowledge traditions.



ANERI SHETH

An interdisciplinary artist and disciple of Guru Mandakini Trivedi, **Aneri Sheth** has pursued Mohiniyattam for over eighteen years while engaging deeply with performance, research, and arts education. Through her work in community outreach, audience development, and the study of Kerala's goddess traditions, she explores how Nāṭya can serve as a bridge between artistic excellence, cultural continuity, and social engagement.



SHIVANGI PANDEY

An aspiring Hindustani classical vocalist pursuing higher studies at Bhatkhande Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya, Lucknow, **Shivangi Pandey** represents a young generation dedicated to deepening its engagement with India's musical heritage. She approaches Nāda as both a discipline of artistic refinement and a lifelong journey of learning and sādhanā.

A SHARED JOURNEY

"Though our disciplines differ, we are united by a shared commitment to artistic excellence, cultural continuity, and lifelong sādhanā. May the friendships, conversations, and insights born during this immersion continue to inspire our individual and collective journeys."

संगच्छध्वं संवदध्वं सं वो मनांसि जानताम्

"Move together. Speak together. Let your minds be of one accord."

— R̥gveda 10.191.2



COMMUNITY OF PRACTICE

Living Lineages



The vitality of Nāṭya lies in its living lineages, where knowledge is transmitted through practice, devotion, and the Guru–Śiṣya Paramparā.

The following practitioners remind us that artistic traditions continue to flourish through communities dedicated to preserving and embodying them.



SREYA SRINATH

A disciple of Dr. Padmaja Suresh, Sreya seeks to explore Nāṭya beyond performance through its philosophical and spiritual dimensions. She experiences dance as an act of worship that brings her into communion with the Divine.



R. GOPALAKRISHNAN

A senior disciple of Melattur Veda Pathashala, R. Gopalakrishnan combines his professional background in engineering with a deep commitment to preserving the temple traditions of Melattur. He regards Nāṭya as both *sevā* and *sādhana*, and contributes actively to the Vidyalaya's work with young students.



POORANI IYER

Based in Bengaluru, Poorani Iyer supports the mission of Bhagavata Mela Vidyalaya through her artistic practice and participation in temple festivals. A law graduate, she experiences Nāṭya as an offering of devotion, community service, and complete surrender.



SHAHANA

An aspiring practitioner of the Bhagavata Mela tradition and a student of architecture in Thanjavur, Shahana represents a new generation of disciples committed to carrying forward this living lineage through disciplined study, temple service, and *sādhana*.



*Paramparā lives wherever knowledge is received with reverence
and transmitted with integrity.*



COMMUNITY OF PRACTICE

THE NEXT GENERATION

Nāṭya flourishes through the living continuity of the Guru-Śiṣya Paramparā.

*The following practitioners represent diverse stages of artistic practice,
united by a shared commitment to learning, cultural continuity,
and lifelong sādhanā.*



HAMSA GANESH

A dedicated Kathak practitioner, Hamsa approaches Nāṭya with the curiosity of a lifelong learner and a deep passion for artistic growth. For her, the practice of dance is a meditative journey that cultivates inner stillness beyond performance.



RUTUJA JANGAM

A senior disciple of Smt. Charanya Gurusathya, Rutuja is a performer, teacher, and postgraduate student of Performing Arts whose journey harmonises practice, pedagogy, and scholarship. She experiences Nāṭya as a lifelong path of self-discovery, devotion, and inner transformation.



NAMITAA CHANDRASHEKHAR

A disciple of Smt. Charanya Gurusathya, Namitaa balances learning, teaching, and performance while continually deepening her engagement with the classical arts. She views Nāṭya as the expression of life itself, transforming inner experience into shared human understanding.



MYTHRI GURUSATHYA

A disciple of Smt. Charanya Gurusathya, Mythri seeks to unite disciplined Bharatanatyam training with philosophical inquiry and creative expression. She understands Nāṭya as a journey of inner awakening, revealing deeper truths through embodied movement.



SHRADDHA HEBBALKAR

A disciple of Smt. Charanya Gurusathya, Shraddha approaches Nāṭya with devotion, discipline, and a spirit of inquiry nurtured through regular Guru-Śiṣya training and temple performances. For her, it is a sacred space where the artist becomes an instrument of the tradition.



RASHMI CHOWALLOOR

A Kuchipudi practitioner, choreographer, and co-founder of Viradhya School of Dance, Rashmi combines rigorous classical training with original creative exploration. Her artistic journey reflects a commitment to preserving tradition while discovering fresh pathways of expression.



VIDHYA S.

A Kuchipudi artist and co-founder of Viradhya School of Dance, Vidhya's work integrates performance, choreography, and pedagogy. Rooted in classical discipline, she continues to explore Nāṭya as a living tradition that speaks meaningfully to contemporary audiences.



DHRUTI SHEKAR

While continuing her advanced training under Smt. Veena Seshadri, Dhruti has recently begun teaching the next generation through her own dance school. She believes Nāṭya has shaped her life profoundly and aspires to share its cultural and spiritual essence with others.

Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu

IMPORTANT NOTES



As part of our effort to conduct a mindful and environmentally conscious immersion, participants are encouraged to carry their own reusable metal water bottles, which may be refilled at the RO drinking water dispenser available at the venue.



Registration begins at 8:00 AM on 11 July.



Kindly be seated at least five minutes before every session.



The immersion concludes at approximately 8:00 PM on 11 July.

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

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Art & Culture Trust
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SEVĀ TEAM

The inaugural Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu Immersion has been supported by a dedicated team of young volunteers whose enthusiasm, diligence, and spirit of sevā have contributed immensely to the planning and organisation of this gathering.

DARAFSHA SHAIKH

A graduate in Civil Services and currently pursuing an M.A. in International Studies at Somaiya Vidyavihar University, Darafsha brings together an interest in public affairs with a deep appreciation for India's cultural traditions. She believes that meaningful service begins with disciplined participation and a willingness to learn.

VASANTI CHOUDHARY

A graduate in Civil Services and currently pursuing an M.A. in International Studies at Somaiya Vidyavihar University, Vasanti is passionate about community service and India's living folk traditions, particularly Garba. She sees cultural participation as a means of fostering social harmony and collective well-being.

FROM IMMERSION TO SĀDHANĀ

May these two days become the beginning of a lifelong journey of study, practice and inner refinement.

May the spirit of Nāma • Rūpa • Nāda • Bindu continue to illuminate your journey.